

Joel Russell

Senior QA Engineer

ABOUT ME

14 years in QA/Testing, most of it spent on systems other teams depend on. Comfortable leading technical decisions, pushing back on scope when it matters, and carrying a pager for what I build. Primary tools: CI/CD and TypeScript.

CAREER HISTORY

Beacon Interactive — Senior QA Engineer

2018-06 — 2026-01 | Dennisville

- Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.
- Set up cross-browser and device coverage in Python, catching defects staging had missed.
- Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 30% to 96%.
- Reduced escaped defects by 55% through risk-based test prioritisation.
- Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.

Nova Tech Group — Quality Engineer

2013-12 — 2018-01 | Nicholschester

- Automated 15 regression suites with Selenium, cutting the manual test cycle by 12%.
- Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 10 hours to 4 minutes through parallelisation.
- Integrated automated checks into the CI/CD pipeline, blocking 15 faulty releases.
- Drove accessibility coverage from 40% to 82% of core journeys.

Google — QA Engineer

2012-09 — 2013-09 | East Gloria (Hybrid)

- Owned release sign-off for 2 services, coordinating across product and support.
- Established test data management practices later adopted by 15 teams.
- Wrote the team's testing strategy, separating unit, contract and end-to-end responsibilities.

QA Analyst, Keystone Apps

2011-05 — 2012-05 | Kellyfurt (Remote)

- Mentored 12 manual testers into automation roles.
- Built a performance harness in pytest simulating 40k concurrent users.
- Led a team of 5 through a full replatforming with no missed delivery dates.

SDET

Stripe | 2010-02 — 2011-01 | Lake Kimberly

- Managed stakeholder communication during a major incident, including the post-mortem.
- Standardised the team's tooling with CI/CD, ending long-running environment drift.
- Interviewed and onboarded 20 new hires, shaping the hiring bar for the team.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Bachelor, Economics

Ashford Technical University | 2006 — 2010

CERTIFICATIONS

Professional Data Engineer — Google Cloud, 2024

PHOTO

CONTACT DETAILS

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TECH STACK

CI/CD, TypeScript, Git, pytest, Python, Jira, GitHub Actions, Cypress, Ruby, Java, REST APIs, Selenium

LANGUAGE SKILLS

English – Bilingual

Portuguese – Conversational

PERSONAL INTERESTS

Board games, Jazz guitar

Google Analytics Certification — Google, 2026
TensorFlow Developer Certificate — Google, 2026

VOLUNTEERING

Volunteer instructor at a weekend coding club for 15 secondary school students.

